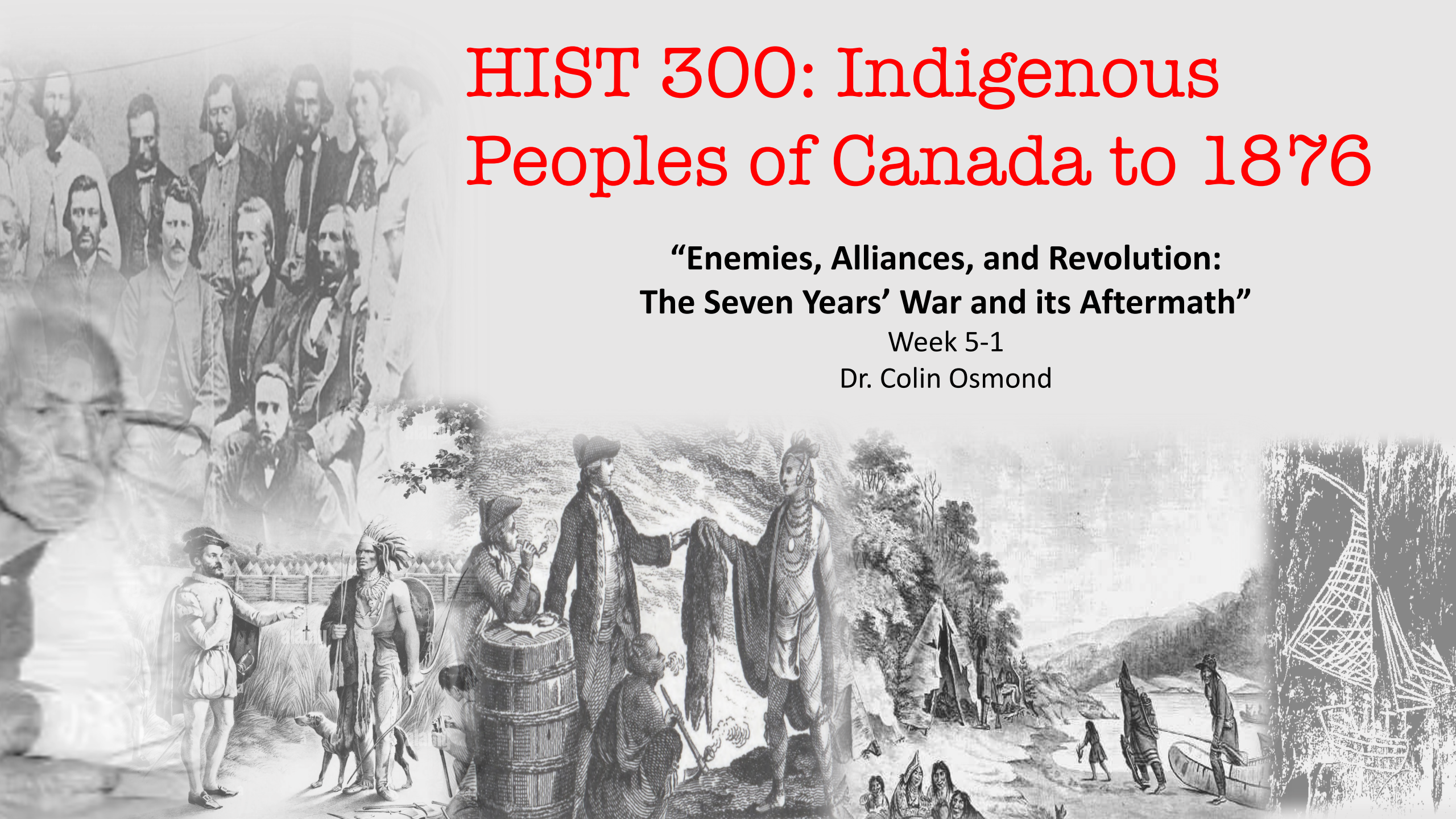
HIST 300: Indigenous Peoples of Canada to 1876

"Enemies, Alliances, and Revolution:
The Seven Years' War and its Aftermath"

Week 5-1

Dr. Colin Osmond



Learning Outcomes/Keyword

- The end of one conflict – the beginning of another
- 18th century was a century of almost constant war
- 7 Years' War and the Fall of New France, the rise of America
- More European Wars on Indigenous Land
- American Revolution – Treaty of Paris 1783
  - Indigenous Lands carved up by colonial forces without Indigenous representation at the Peace negotiations (a theme is emerging….)
- *Keywords: Fall of New France, Royal Proclamation, British North America, Province of Quebec, Obwandiyang's (Pontaic's) War, biological warfare,Thayendanegea, Grand River, Haldimand Grant, American Revolution, Treaty of Paris 1783, Whites, Indians*

French and Indian War – 7 Years' War

- 1754-1763
- North American Theatre - Indigenous people sided with different colonial forces
- Wabanaki, Algonquin, some Anishinaabe, some Wendat sided with French
- Some Haudenosaunee (but most remained neutral), Cherokee, some Wendat sided with English
- Most of the fighting was done in the interior – in places largely controlled by Indigenous empires

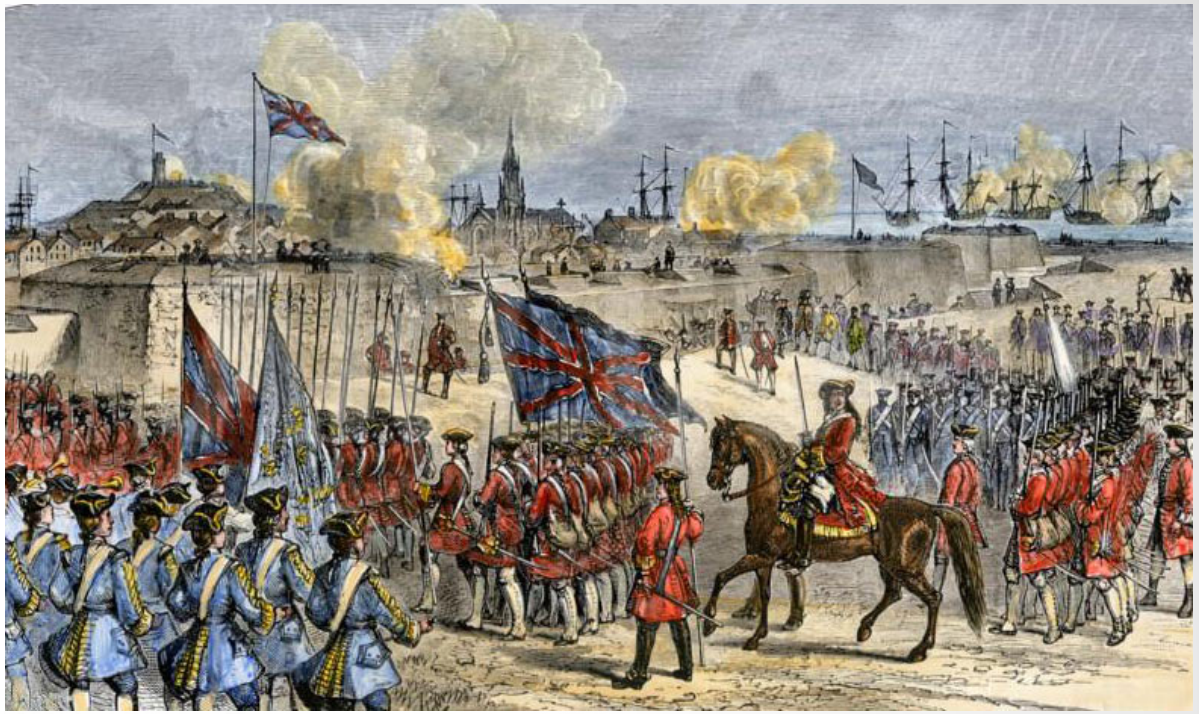
French and Indian War – 7 Years' War

- By start of war, Indigenous Empires had incorporated Europeans into their economic world
- Indigenous people controlled the supply of furs – dictated the price and controlled the market
- The 7 Years' War was a major blow to Indigenous economies
- French allied Indigenous militias dominated the British
- French Command disliked the Indigenous militia's guerilla tactics
- After a few years of French victories – British pushed back and overtook French/Indigenous forces
- By 1758 – French had lost most of its colonial territory


Hudson Bay
NEW FRANCE
Wolfe
Ft. Louisbourg
(Jun. 8–Jul. 26, 1758)
Ft. Beausejour
Quebec
L. Superior
Montreal
Amherst
Port Royal
Amherst
Ft. Ticonderoga
(Jul. 8, 1758)
L. Huron
Ft. Frontenac
(Aug. 27, 1758)
Ft. William Henry
(Aug. 9, 1757)
Ft. Niagara
(Jul. 29, 1759)
Ft. Oswego
Ft. Stanwix
Boston
L. Michigan
Albany
Detroit
L. Erie
New York
Braddock's defeat
(Aug. 9 ,1755)
Ft. Duquesne
Philadelphia
Ft. Necessity
(Jul. 3, 1754)
Ft. Cumberland
Atlantic Ocean
St. Louis
LOUISIANA
Williamsburg
NORTH CAROLINA
SOUTH CAROLINA
GEORGIA
Charleston
Savannah
Natchez
SPANISH FLORIDA
St. Augustine
New Orleans
Gulf of Mexico
French claims
British claims
Spanish claims
Disputed British-Spanish claims
Disputed British-French claims
British victories
French victories
Forts
British troops movements

Siege of Louisbourg, 1758









A View of the Taking of QUEBEC September 13th 1759

Shewing the manner of debarking the English Forces, & of the resolute scrambling of the light Infantry, up a Woody Precipice to dislodge the Captains post, which defended a small entrenched path, through which the Troops were to pass. Also a view of the signal Victory obtained over the French regulars, Canadians and Indians, which produced the surrender of Quebec.

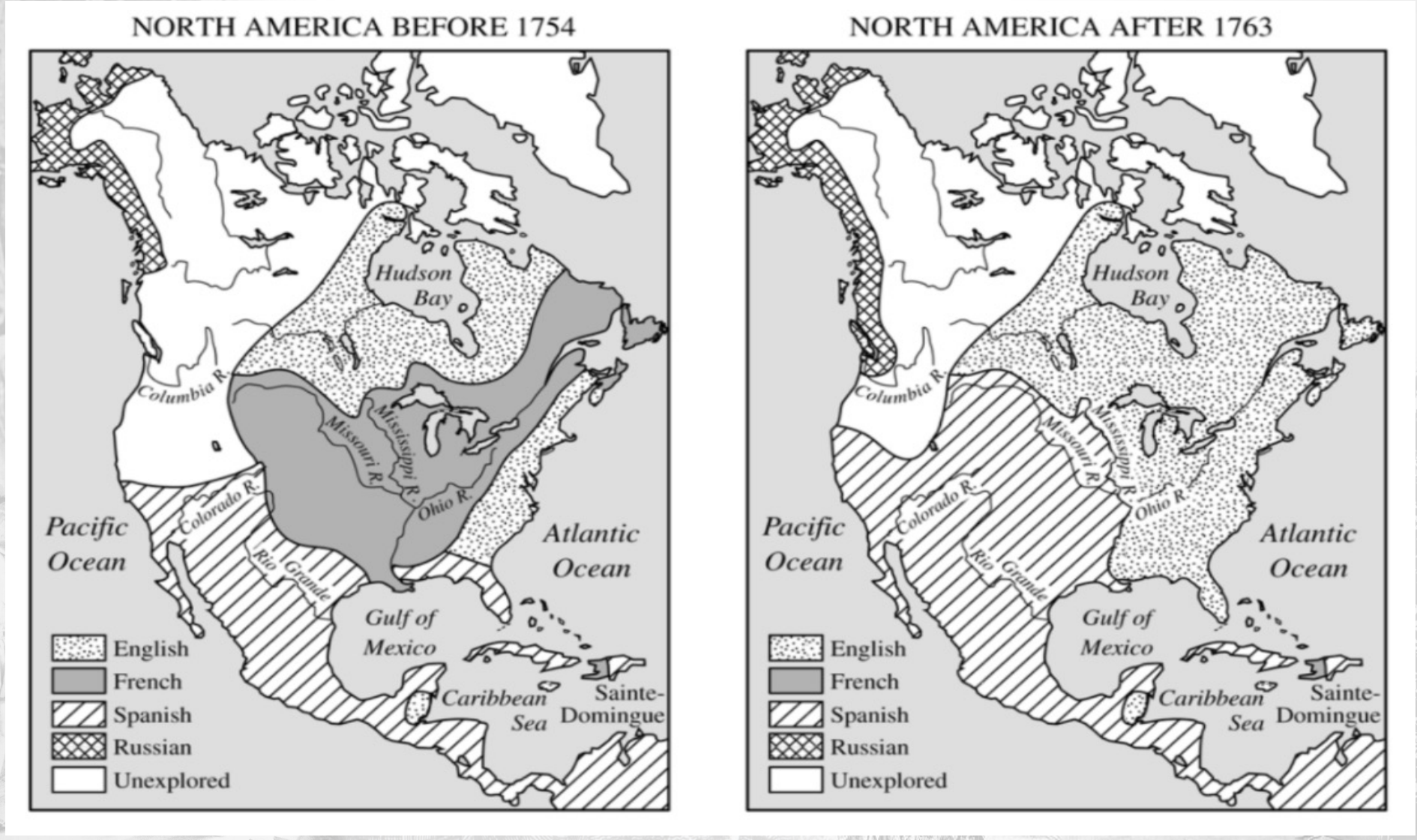
Published 1st November 1797. by LAURIE & WHITTLE, 53 Fleet Street. London.

Vüe de la Prise de QUEBEC *le* 13 Septembre 1759.

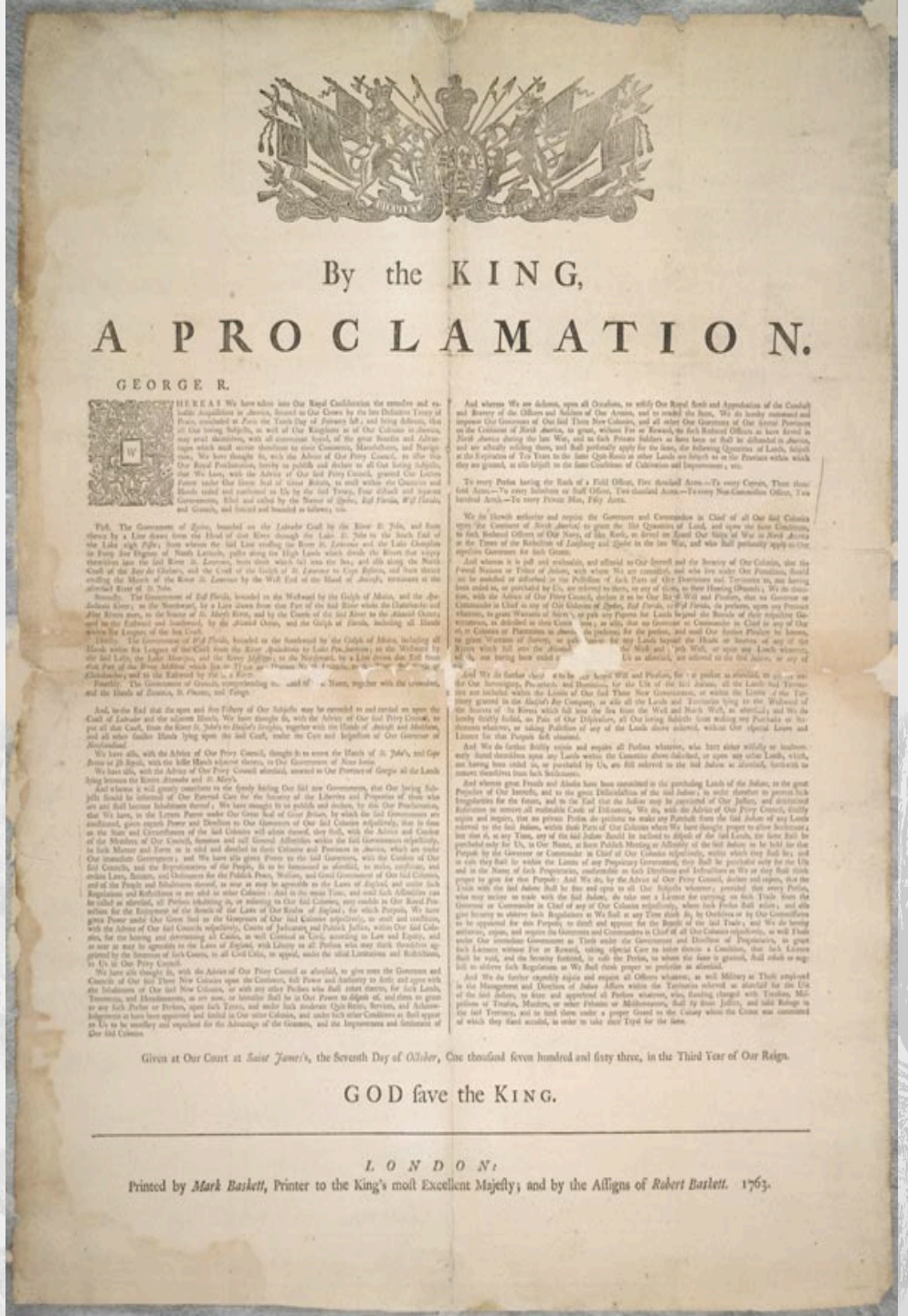
Qui Represente le débarquement des Troupes Angloises, & L'Intrépidité de L'Infanterie Legere en Escaladant un Précipice Boiseux &. pour déloger le poste du Capitaine qui défendoit un Sentier retranché par où les Troupes devoient passer. Aussi la vüe de la Victoire Signalé Remportée Sur les Francois, Canadiens & Indiens qui obligua la Ville à Capituler.



Colonial C[illegible] Years' War



- A way to calm Indigenous governments who were mad about their lands being carved up by colonial governments
- Remember- for much of the land European powers claimed, they had no presence on the ground
- British also needed a way to control settler expansion
- Created the “Proclamation Line”
- Recognized Indigenous people had rights to their lands
- Put in place a process for settlers to obtain Indigenous lands – only the British could negotiate Indigenous land surrenders/transfer/purchases
- Made American settlers mad – undermined ”Manifest Destiny”
- This document is the basis for many Indigenous land claims today



By the KING,

A PROCLAMATION.

GEORGE R.

Given at Our Court at *Saint James's*, the Seventh Day of *October*, One thousand seven hundred and sixty three, in the Third Year of Our Reign.

GOD save the KING.

LONDON:

Printed by *Mark Baskett*, Printer to the King's most Excellent Majesty; and by the Assigns of *Robert Baskett*. 1763.

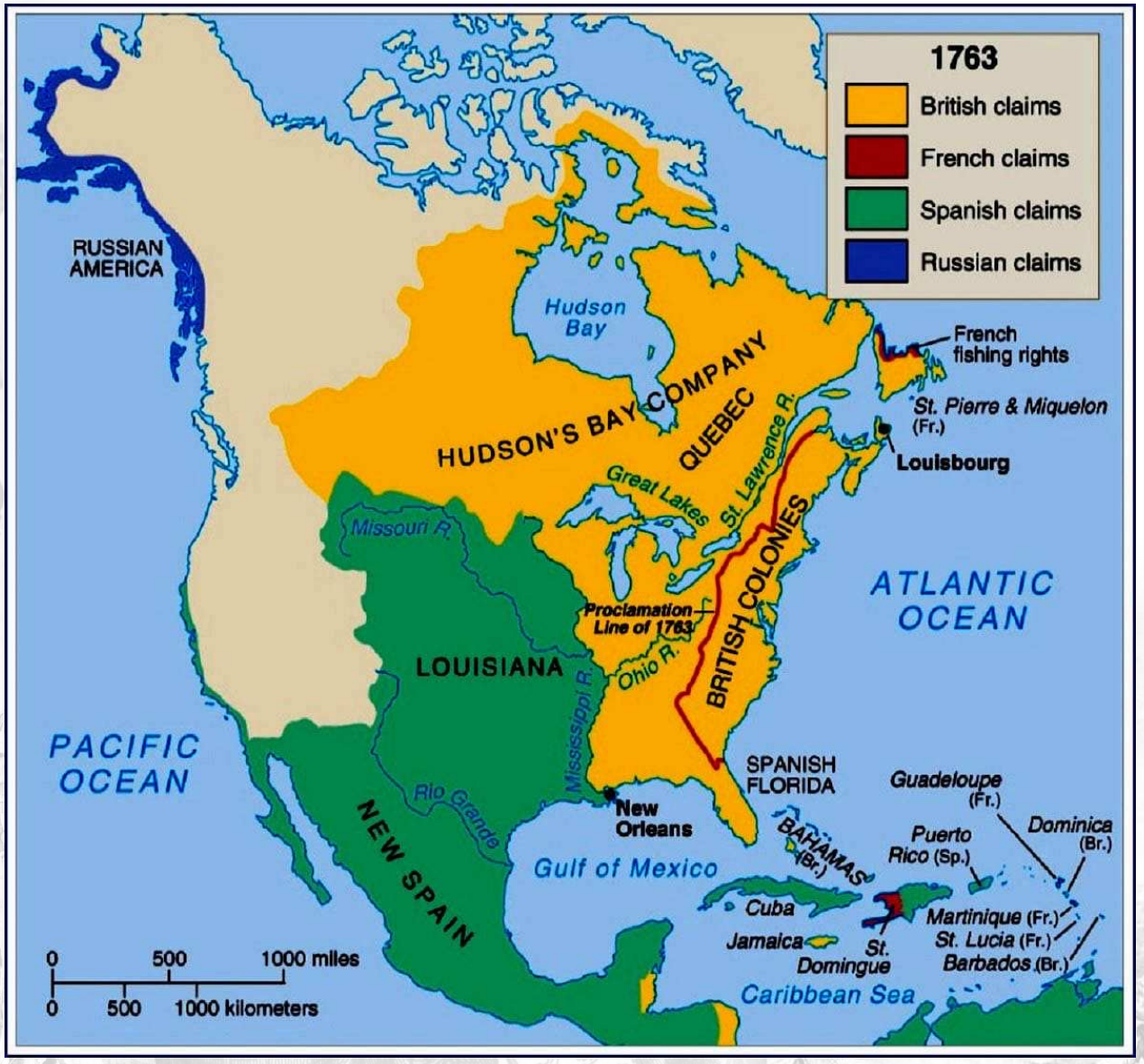

New England
Mid-Atlantic
Upper South
Lower South
Proclamation Line of 1763

The Fall of New France

- “Paper Empires” on Indigenous land
- End of 7 Years’ War had huge implications for Indigenous people
- British occupation of French claims
- French diplomacy vs. British Expansionism
- In the ashes of New France, the roots of British North America



French Surrender at Quebec City, 1759

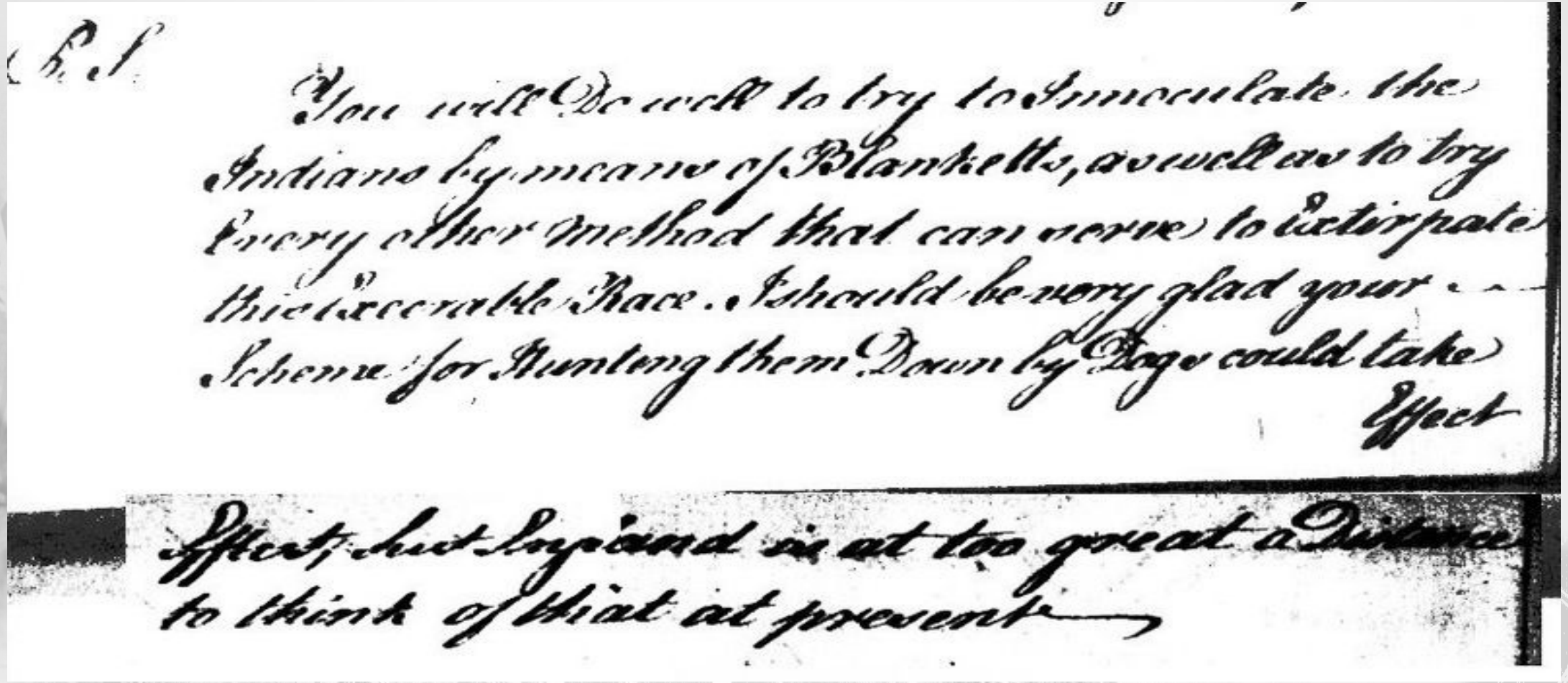

1763
British claims
French claims
Spanish claims
Russian claims
RUSSIAN AMERICA
Hudson Bay
HUDSON'S BAY COMPANY
QUEBEC
French fishing rights
St. Pierre & Miquelon (Fr.)
Louisbourg
Great Lakes
St. Lawrence R.
BRITISH COLONIES
Missouri R.
Proclamation Line of 1763
Ohio R.
LOUISIANA
ATLANTIC OCEAN
PACIFIC OCEAN
Mississippi R.
SPANISH FLORIDA
Guadeloupe (Fr.)
Dominica (Br.)
Rio Grande
New Orleans
BAHAMAS (Br.)
Puerto Rico (Sp.)
NEW SPAIN
Gulf of Mexico
Cuba
Martinique (Fr.)
St. Lucia (Fr.)
Jamaica
St. Domingue
Barbados (Br.)
Caribbean Sea
0 500 1000 miles
0 500 1000 kilometers



”The Siege of the Fort at Detroit”, 1763.



Obwandiyang/Pontiac



"You will Do well to try to Innoculate the Indians by means of Blanketts, as well as to try every other method that can serve to Extirpate this Execrable Race. I should be very glad your Scheme for hunting them Down by Dogs could take Effect but England is at too great a Distance to think of that at present."

Governor Jeffrey Amherst, 1763

Discussion!

- Did the British use biological warfare in the Ohio Valley?
- Were they successful (were they responsible for the epidemic)?
- If so, why didn't they continue to do this elsewhere?
- Does it matter if they were successful?
- Is the intent bad enough?
- What do we make of Amherst's reputation today?
  - Amherst, Nova Scotia
  - Amherst College in Amherst Massachusetts
  - "Lord Jeff" (no longer the official mascot!)



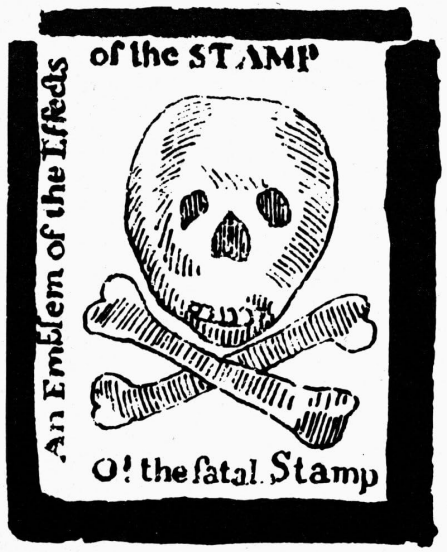
End of Pontiac's War

- Obwandiyang's forces had significant victories in 1763-64
- By end of 1764, many of his followers left to go hunting
- Smallpox ravaged the region
- British had bulked up – 10,000 soldiers to the Ohio Valley
- 1766 – Obwandiyang agrees to peace talks
- No real winner – a war of stalemates
- Obwandiyang treated as an outcast – a failure
- Killed by a Peoria assassin near Cahokia in 1769
- Pontiac – a real life hero, or mythic figure?



VISIT OF PONTIAC AND THE INDIANS TO MAJOR GLADWIN.

The Indigenous Roots of the American Revolution



- Royal Proclamation restricted western expansion
  - Americans saw Proclamation Line as against their rights as colonists
- Stamp Act, 1765
  - Tax fund used to pay for 10,000 troops on western edge of Colonial America
- Both of these Government documents were designed to control and manage Indigenous people on the edges of the British Empire
- Therefore – the issues that resulting in the founding of the United States were rooted in Indigenous land rights

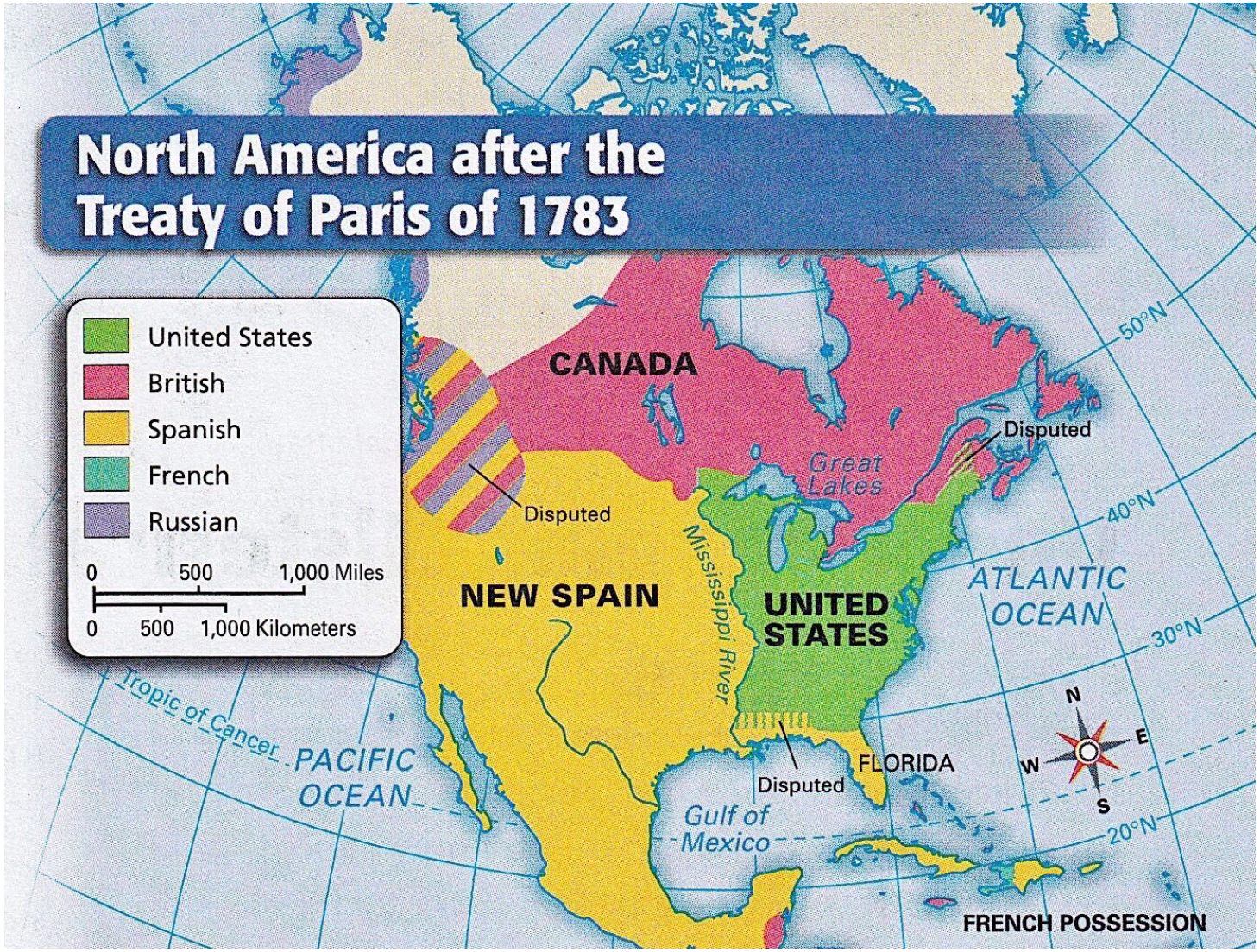
Thayendanegea (Joseph Brant) and the American Revolution

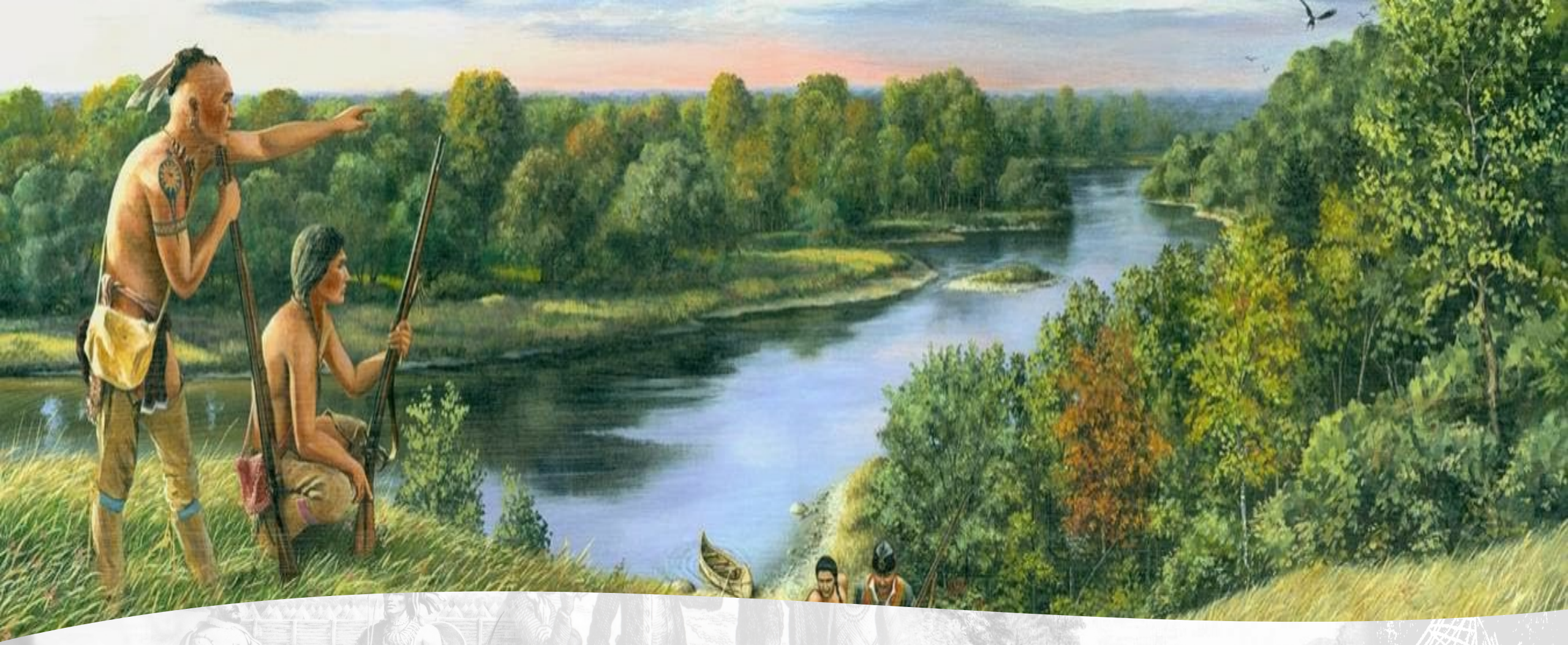
- Indigenous groups brought into another conflict – had to decide who to support or stay neutral
- Some thought British, and their shiny new Royal Proclamation was a better option than the aggressive and expansionist Americans
- Others thought they could carve space for an Indigenous Nation by following American calls for “Liberty and Justice”
- Thayendanegea/Joseph Brant – Haudenosaunee Leader allied with the British
- Some Haudenosaunee wanted to create an Indigenous Nation to the west that could stop European expansion – and they thought the British would support this given the recently created “Proclamation Line”
- For most Indigenous Nations – especially those in the borderlands – neutrality was not an option



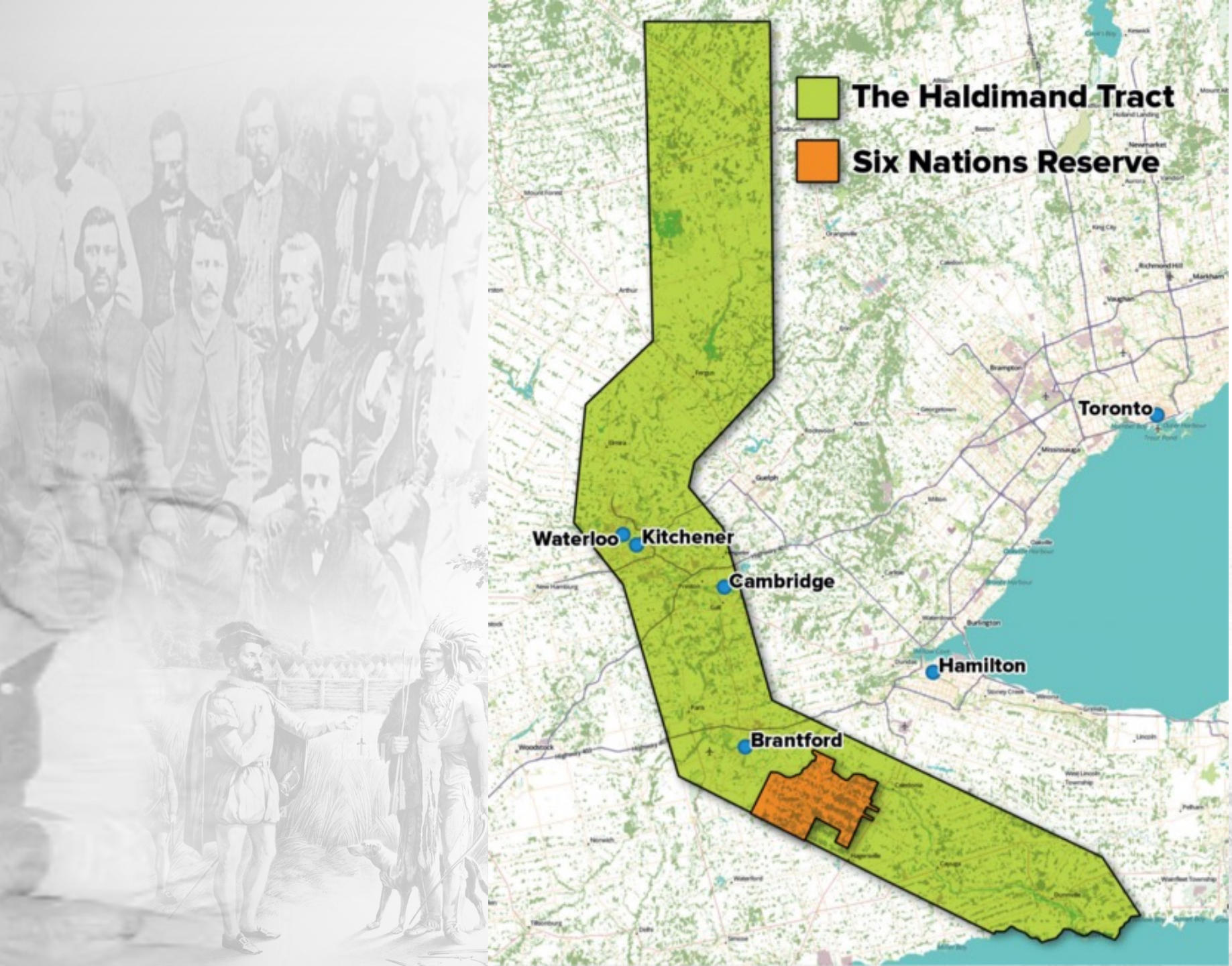
(Another) Treaty of Paris, 1783

- British capitulated all of their claims south of the Great Lakes to the Americans
- Americans recognized British claims in the north and Atlantic
- Indigenous people were not part of these negotiations – even though it was their unceded land being divided.





Haudenosaunee Scouting village sites on the Grand River
(courtesy of the Six Nations of the Grand River)



The Haldimand Tract
Six Nations Reserve
Toronto
Waterloo
Kitchener
Cambridge
Hamilton
Brantford



Conclusion:

- From explorers and missionaries, to soldiers and settlers
- After American Revolution Indigenous people become less important as strategic military allies
- For all the complexity – Indigenous Nations become “Indians”, French, American, British, Dutch become “whites”
- Going forward – from small colonies to settler colonial Nation States
- BUT – Indigenous people remain active agents who make decisions (agency!) – not passive victims of settler colonialism

Next Class:

- **Oct 9 Horses, Guns, and Germs – The Great Plains**

Read: Geoff Cunfer, “Overview: The Decline and Fall of the Bison Empire”, 1-29.

Belshaw: Pgs. 56-64

